Diego López Tamayo

Empirical Economist — Applied Econometrics, Digital Economics & Machine Learning

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PROFILE

Empirical economist with 5+ years in industry research at BBVA Research and prior academic research experience, measuring economic outcomes across sectors and regions in Mexico and the US. Research on digital platforms (Airbnb, ridesharing), network economics, competition and technology adoption. I bridge applied econometrics with scalable Python/PySpark pipelines and NLP/LLM methods for unstructured data, and translate results into clear narratives for executives, business units and policymakers.

Applied econometrics	**Digital economics**	**ML on unstructured data**	**Translating insight**
Hedonic pricing, panel data, time series, forecasting, merger & damages analysis	Platform markets, network economics, innovation & technology adoption	NLP, topic models, embeddings, LLM fine-tuning, PySpark big data	Published research, advisory to business & risk leadership, teaching

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Senior Economist · BBVA Research, Mexico City — Jun 2021 – Present

- Produce sector- and region-level economic analysis and forecasts for Mexico and the US across manufacturing, energy, telecommunications, transport and international trade.
- Lead Big Data projects, building scalable workflows in Python, PySpark and SQL to extract economic signals from large-scale datasets.
- Advise business and risk units on data-driven economic strategy; author public research reports for executive, client and policy audiences (bbvaresearch.com/author/diego-lopez).
- Selected for BBVA's International Development Program at BBVA Garanti, Istanbul (Nov 2024).

Research Assistant (CONACyT) · Center for Economics & Foresight of Science and Technology (CEPCyT) — Jan 2016 – Jul 2019

- Research on the economics of innovation and evaluation of entrepreneurship projects, with Dr. Leonel Corona Treviño.

Local Consultant · International Business Research, University of Groningen — Mar – Sep 2019

- Market studies of the Mexican dairy sector for an international research consortium.

RESEARCH & PUBLICATIONS

Hedonic Price Analysis for Airbnb in Mexico City — 2021

El Colegio de México, Working Paper No. VII-2021. With Aurora A. Ramírez-Álvarez. Econometric estimation of how listing, host and location attributes drive prices on a digital platform.

Economic, Distributive and Environmental Effects of Removing IUSC Exemptions in Costa Rica — 2021

Policy research for the UN Economic Commission for Latin America and the Caribbean (ECLAC). With Francisco Castillo Cerdas and Carlos A. López Morales.

Digital Platforms in Mexico: Ridesharing in Mexico City — 2019

B.A. thesis, UNAM (with honors). Market structure and effects of ride-hailing platforms.

Industry research reports

Sector and regional outlooks for Mexico and the US, BBVA Research (2021 – present).

EDUCATION

M.A. in Economics · El Colegio de México (CEE) 2019 – 2021
Thesis: Hedonic Price Analysis for Airbnb in Mexico City.

B.A. in Economics, with honors · UNAM 2014 – 2019
Thesis: Digital Platforms in Mexico — Ridesharing in Mexico City.

Exchange Program · University of Warwick, UK — Upper Second Jan – Jul 2018
Time Series Econometrics, Industrial Organization, Labour Economics.

Quantitative Methods for Competition Analysis · Barcelona School of Economics May – Jun 2023
Market definition, merger analysis and damages estimation.

International Economics · LSE Summer School Jun – Jul 2024
International trade theory and policy; international macroeconomics.

ML & DATA SCIENCE TRAINING

Natural Language Processing · Bourbaki, Data Science Track Feb – Mar 2024
Sentiment analysis, BoW, TF-IDF, regularization, topic modeling (LDA), word embeddings, encoder-decoder models, fine-tuning and LLMs (BERT, GPT).

Data Specialist Fundamentals · BBVA Campus Apr – Jun 2022
Exploratory analysis in Python and SQL; statistics and machine learning on Spark (PySpark) for big data.

Intermediate Machine Learning: Feature Engineering · Universidad Carlos III de Madrid Oct – Dec 2021
Boosting, support vector machines, multivariate analysis, dimensionality reduction.

TEACHING

Lecturer · El Colegio de México Jan 2023 – Present
Network Economics (M.A.): theoretical models and network-formation algorithms in Python with NetworkX. Financial Accounting (B.A.), based on CFA Financial Statement Analysis.

Instructor, faculty courses · Universidad de Guanajuato May – Jun 2022
Intermediate Python for Economists for Economics & Finance faculty (SciPy, GeoPandas, Seaborn, NetworkX). Statistical Analysis with Stata: panel-data and time-series econometrics.

Teaching Assistant · Faculty of Economics, UNAM 2017 – 2018
Quantitative Methods; Economic Theories of Innovation.

SKILLS

Python	pandas, NumPy, scikit-learn, SciPy, NetworkX, GeoPandas, Seaborn
Data & stats	R, Stata, PySpark, SQL
Tools	Git, LaTeX, Power BI, Looker Studio, MS Office · Portfolio: diego-eco.github.io/toolkit.html
Languages	Spanish (native) · English (TOEFL iBT 108) · French (DELF B2)